

IT Deployment Guide — resiDNA Streamlit App

Handoff notes for making this app privately and securely reachable inside the company, instead of the Demo Streamlit Community Cloud link. Two realistic paths are below: pure on-prem/local hosting, and hosting on Azure with the app embedded in SharePoint. Both need the same core hardening; SharePoint just changes where users click to get there.

Decided: Option A (on-prem/local server). For the concrete, from-scratch execution of the steps below — actual commands, service files, and config templates, written for someone starting with nothing set up — see `IT_Setup_Guide_OptionA.md`. Option B stays documented here for reference in case that decision is revisited.

What's already true about the app (no changes needed here)

- `app.py` processes uploaded files entirely in memory — parses with `pandas`, renders `Plotly` charts, builds the PDF in memory for download. By default, nothing is written to disk or a database on the server, and nothing persists once a session ends.
- Exception: an opt-in audit log (`app/audit_log.py`), off unless the `RESIDNA_AUDIT_LOG` environment variable is set — see Option A step 7 below. Off by default means the Community Cloud demo's documented behavior (nothing persisted) is unaffected unless someone deliberately enables it there too.
- The app itself has no authentication, no TLS, and no persistent-service setup — all three need to be added by hosting infrastructure, not the app code.

Option A — On-Prem / Local Server Hosting

1. Host on a company-controlled server or VM on the internal network — not exposed to the public internet.
2. Run it as a persistent service, not a terminal session (today, closing the terminal or rebooting stops the app):
 - Linux: a `systemd` unit, or a Docker container with a restart policy.
 - Windows: an NSSM-wrapped service, a Windows container, or Task Scheduler running at startup.
3. Put a reverse proxy in front (Nginx, IIS, or the company's existing load balancer) to:
 - Terminate TLS with a company-issued certificate, so the internal URL is `https://`.
 - Sit between users and the Streamlit process so raw/unauthenticated traffic never reaches it directly.
4. Add authentication — Streamlit has native login support for this: `st.login()` with an `[auth]` block in `.streamlit/secrets.toml`, using OpenID Connect. It works with any OIDC provider, including Microsoft Entra ID, so employees can log in with their existing company account rather than a separate password. (Streamlit docs)
 - Alternative: an auth proxy in front of the app (e.g. `oauth2-proxy`) if IT prefers to keep auth entirely outside the app.
5. Restrict network reachability: bind to an internal DNS name/IP only, gate with firewall rules or VPN-only access — no public inbound port.
6. Dependency versions are pinned: `app/requirements.txt` lists exact tested versions — reproduce the environment from it as-is and run it through standard vulnerability scanning before go-live.
7. Enable the audit log: compliance has confirmed an audit trail is required, and it's built — `app/audit_log.py` appends one record per generated PDF report (timestamp, uploaded filename, a SHA-256 hash of it, assay/run info, submitter/reviewer name, and pass/fail — never the actual analytical results) to `Logs/audit.log`. It's off unless the `RESIDNA_AUDIT_LOG` environment variable is set on the server process — see `IT_Setup_Guide_OptionA.md` steps 4–6 for the exact service config and log retention/rotation setup.

Option B — Azure Hosting + SharePoint Embed

SharePoint itself cannot run a Python/Streamlit backend — there's no application runtime inside SharePoint Online for that. What is realistic:

1. Host the app on infrastructure your Microsoft tenant controls — Azure App Service (Linux, native Python support) or Azure Container Apps, inside your tenant's network/VNet.
2. Enable Entra ID authentication on the Azure side — either Azure App Service's built-in authentication ("Easy Auth") or the app's own `st.login()` OIDC flow pointed at your Entra tenant — so it matches company SSO.
3. Embed the hosted app in a SharePoint page using the built-in Embed web part (an `iframe` pointed at the internal Azure URL). This gives users the experience of it living inside SharePoint, while Azure remains the actual security boundary.
4. Configure the Azure-hosted app to allow being framed by your SharePoint domain. SharePoint Online enforces a Content-Security-Policy that blocks framing from arbitrary external origins. The fix is on the app's hosting config — set a `Content-Security-Policy: frame-ancestors` header (or equivalent App Service setting) that explicitly allows `https://yourtenant.sharepoint.com`. There is no Entra ID or SharePoint-side setting that bypasses this — it has to be granted by the app's own host.
5. Steps 5–7 from Option A (network restriction scope, dependency pinning, logging/audit policy) still apply — embedding in SharePoint is a UI convenience, not a substitute for the same hardening.

Before either option goes live

- Keep `residna.streamlit.app` (Community Cloud) as a demo-only URL — use the company-hosted deployment for real data once it's live.
- `app/requirements.txt` is already pinned — build whichever environment from it as-is so it matches what's been tested.

Sources

- User authentication and information — Streamlit Docs
- `st.login` — Streamlit Docs
- Embed SharePoint / CSP frame-ancestors discussion — Microsoft Q&A